Toronto Produce Market Update - week of December 13, 2022

Source: USDA AMS Market News, Toronto terminal market (data from Infohort, Agriculture and Agri-Food Canada), converted to CAD at the Bank of Canada rate. 22 items quoted this week. Prices are wholesale per case.

Headline

- Basket moved **+5.9%** week over week (like-for-like quotes).
- **13 items need a price increase** to hold target margin; 4 have room to sharpen price or promote.
- Supply switches this week: Celery (California -> Canada), Roma tomatoes (Canada -> Mexico).

Biggest moves (week over week)

Rising	Change	Falling	Change
Field tomatoes	+40%	Zucchini	-26%
Strawberries	+39%	Carrots	-8%
Cauliflower	+23%	Avocados	-7%
Broccoli	+21%		
Green leaf lettuce	+20%		

Pricing actions (list price built on the average cost of up to 4 prior weeks)

Item	Cost now (CAD/case)	Margin at current list	Target	Action	Suggested price
Green leaf lettuce	$126.09	-37%	27%	Raise price	$183.09
Iceberg lettuce	$147.53	-30%	25%	Raise price	$208.51
Romaine lettuce	$139.07	-29%	27%	Raise price	$201.93
Strawberries	$52.05	-12%	30%	Raise price	$78.83
Field tomatoes	$45.00	-6%	28%	Raise price	$66.24
Broccoli	$47.47	-5%	27%	Raise price	$68.93
Roma tomatoes	$40.05	-5%	28%	Raise price	$58.97
Grape tomatoes	$34.86	12%	30%	Raise price	$52.79
Cauliflower	$49.69	16%	27%	Raise price	$72.16
Yellow onions	$27.20	16%	22%	Raise price	$36.96
Apples (tray pack)	$57.36	16%	25%	Raise price	$81.07
English cucumbers	$13.35	22%	27%	Raise price	$19.39
Kale (bunched)	$40.55	22%	30%	Raise price	$61.40
Limes	$51.18	34%	28%	Lower price / promote	$75.34
Carrots	$17.06	35%	22%	Lower price / promote	$23.18
Celery	$37.58	37%	25%	Lower price / promote	$53.11
Zucchini	$20.77	44%	27%	Lower price / promote	$30.16

Next 4 weeks: seasonal outlook (half-strength seasonal index, 2017-2020)

- Typically **easing**: Strawberries (-15%), Romaine lettuce (-12%), Green leaf lettuce (-12%), Iceberg lettuce (-9%).
- Typically **firming**: Zucchini (+19%), English cucumbers (+11%), Limes (+11%), Asparagus (+6%).
- Seasonal outlook is a planning signal, not a weekly forecast: week to week, the latest price is the best predictor (see backtest).

Full item table

Item	CAD/case	WoW	vs 4-wk avg	Lead origin	Action
Strawberries	$52.05	+39%	+60%	United States	Raise price

Item	CAD/case	WoW	vs 4-wk avg	Lead origin	Action
Broccoli	$47.47	+21%	+44%	United States	Raise price
Brussels sprouts	$30.66	0%	-1%	Canada	Hold
Cauliflower	$49.69	+23%	+16%	United States	Raise price
Apples (tray pack)	$57.36	0%	+11%	Washington	Raise price
Avocados	$16.36	-7%	-3%	Mexico	Hold
Bananas	$30.66	+2%	+4%	Ecuador	Hold
Limes	$51.18	0%	-8%	Mexico	Lower price / promote
English cucumbers	$13.35	+4%	+7%	Canada	Raise price
Zucchini	$20.77	-26%	-24%	Mexico	Lower price / promote
Green leaf lettuce	$126.09	+20%	+88%	United States	Raise price
Iceberg lettuce	$147.53	+15%	+74%	California	Raise price
Kale (bunched)	$40.55	+3%	+11%	Canada	Raise price
Romaine lettuce	$139.07	+10%*	+77%	California	Raise price
Asparagus	$39.12	0%	-6%	Mexico	Hold
Carrots	$17.06	-8%	-16%	Canada	Lower price / promote
Celery	$37.58	+14%	-17%	Canada	Lower price / promote
Potatoes	$31.65	0%	-3%	Canada	Hold
Yellow onions	$27.20	0%	+8%	Canada	Raise price
Field tomatoes	$45.00	+40%	+47%	Florida	Raise price
Grape tomatoes	$34.86	0%	+26%	Canada	Raise price
Roma tomatoes	$40.05	+7%	+45%	Mexico	Raise price

* No identical quote last week (different origin or size), so the change compares this week's and last week's typical price.

Margins assume a 6% freight and handling allowance and illustrative target margins by category (config/basket.csv).